



AI replaces Microsoft journalists

Microsoft is laying off dozens of journalists working at Microsoft News and MSN in favour of AI. <https://digit.in/jun20-52>



Video piracy has peaked

Data investigation company GuardiaLey Ltd. reported a sharp increase in piracy during global lockdowns. <https://digit.in/jun20-53>

STORYTELLING THROUGH COLOUR

Colour plays a vital role in visual storytelling

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Back in the day, films used to be black and white. They stuck to the script and told stories to the audience in a linear fashion. Conveying any deeper meanings within the script was only possible via interviews held later on or it was to be achieved via cinematography. Not to mention, there was not much room for flexibility in terms of camera work at that time. Years later, colour pictures started showing up in theatres around the globe. As you could imagine, it garnered quite a bit of attraction and opened up a wide array of possibilities for the future of filmmaking. Gradually, directors started implementing additional colours as tints or hues via lighting or filters to convey their ideology behind a certain moment in the film. This further assists in triggering an emotional response from the audience. Knowing how to use colours to create a mood or an additional level of subtext is extremely difficult to pull off. This understanding of the usage of colour to tell a story is called colour theory.

Changes in colours are something that the human eye can instantly take notice of. What makes usage of colour theory unique is that its

effects are often forgotten by the end of the movie. And that is by design.

The whole point of implementing specific colours to certain scenes is to intensify and reflect the emotions the director wants to convey to the audience. Most of the time, the audience is not even aware of it. It is supposed to be felt then and there, at the moment. Once the scene is done, you no longer feel any emotions towards it. It is done and dusted. Colours can be used to create tension, peace or bring attention to certain objects or elements in the film. Colours that are bold or instantaneously visible to eyes exhibit stronger emotions. While weaker colour schemes exhibit subtle emotions. For example, a strong colour such as red exhibits feelings of rising blood pressure, tension or rage. While the colour blue represents calmness, peace and harmony. Although there are some base rules set for colour theory in terms of their usage, it is ultimately up to the film's tone and the director to use it in whatever way they please to convey their emotion or philosophy. For instance, the colour red could sometimes be used to exhibit emotions such as fear, sensuality, death and hope. Sometimes it just depends upon the genre. The colour blue is most commonly used in sci-fi movies to give it a technological, futuristic or space exploration feel depending upon the plot. At the same time, colours could also be used to highlight character development. It all comes down to the director's vision in terms of storytelling. Let us now take a look

at some of the movies and TV shows that used colours to amplify their storytelling visually.

GOOD TIME (2017)

Directed by Josh Safdie and Benny Safdie aka The Safdie Brothers, Good Time follows the story of a convict trying to free his mentally challenged brother from prison, after a botched bank robbery. The film is an extremely thrilling, heart-thumping, anxiety-inducing ride. Other than the script, cinematography and music, the film uses halogen lights to implement colour and further intensify the story. Here the directors use colour to exhibit the characters' emotions



A still from Good Time highlighting rising tension through the colour red

to the situation and their surroundings and then trigger the exact same emotions from the audience. The film constantly shifts between moments of tension and calmness. For scenes involving rising tension, anxiety and rage the film uses red-coloured lighting. This creates a sense of rising blood pressure and urgency within the film. The same levels of stress and anxiety are reflected in the audience and it forces them to relate to the characters' situation.